PRE-SEED ROUND · $500K · OCTOBER 2026

APOC Sell Station

The self-service buy counter for resale stores. Sellers scan their own clothes, staff make the call, and every garment becomes digital inventory.

Tags Technologies

NVIDIA Inception · AWS Activate

Robert Jackson, Founder & CEO

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The buy counter is the bottleneck in a $53B market.

5–10

minutes per item, by hand

Read the tag, search the brand, pull comps, decide, print.

6–12

items per buyer-hour

One buyer, one bag at a time, while the line waits.

40%+

annual staff turnover

Training a buyer takes months; the expertise leaves with them.

Sellers wait hours for a buyer to come free. Offers vary with who is at the counter. Stores lose $50K+ a year in buy-counter labor and still turn sellers away.

US resale market $53B (2024), growing 15% a year · store figures: Tags Technologies store model

The insight: let the seller do the intake, and let staff make the call.

TODAY

One buyer does everything

Identification, condition, pricing, data entry and the judgment call all sit with one person, one bag at a time. Throughput is capped by headcount.

WITH APOC

The machine does the reading, the buyer keeps the decision

Sellers scan their own items at a self-service station and see a pre-offer in about 30 seconds. Staff verify a whole drop in minutes. Nothing pays out without a human.

Why now: vision AI is finally reliable enough to show a seller, chains are labor-constrained, and a human-in-the-loop design is the one store owners will accept.

From a 10-minute intake to a 30-second scan.

01

Lay it flat

The seller places an item on the lit board and closes the clear lid.

02

APOC reads it

Brand, type, size, condition and measurements; the label through the tag reader.

03

Pre-offer

Priced from live comps and the store's own buy list.

04

Staff verify

A whole drop reviewed in minutes; the store pays at the register.

Freestanding, about 1 m wide. No cash hardware, no counter space taken.



Concept render. Prototype not yet built.

The working bench rig runs the same software today

Geometry checks flag inconsistent AI outputs for human review.

1 · Classical computer vision

Measures the garment and checks its type from shape, under controlled lighting and a calibrated camera.

2 · Generative AI

Identifies brand, style and era, cross-checked against OCR of the sewn-in label.

3 · Cross-checks

When the model and the geometry disagree, the item is flagged for a person instead of being priced automatically.

WHY ONE SIGNAL IS NOT ENOUGH

Vision models misread low-contrast items

A second, independent measurement catches many of those errors.

Phone photos vary with every store's lighting

A fixed camera and lights make scans comparable across stores.

Every offer is traceable

Each scan records which checks decided it, and a person signs off.

A working bench system, and the tools to improve it with every scan.

2,500+
garments scanned in bench testing

~30 sec
average from capture to priced offer on the bench rig

0
store deployments yet; the first pilot is the next milestone

Component	What it does	Status
Bench MVP	Dual-camera capture, CV and AI analysis, comps pricing, offer and tag print.	Working on bench rig
Automatic calibration	Printed markers on the scan board replace hand calibration; no manual tuning.	Built Oct 2026; rig test next
Accuracy loop	Staff-verified scans become labeled examples; any miss can be replayed and fixed.	Built Oct 2026; collecting labels
Sell Station prototype	Two units for a 90-day pilot in two New Orleans stores.	Planned Q1 2027
Programs	NVIDIA Inception member; AWS Activate credits.	Active

Bench figures: Tags Technologies test logs

A station pays for itself in about six days of labor.

Typical store, per week	Value
Items taken in	1,000
Buyer time saved per item	5 min
Hours saved	83
Labor value at $20 an hour	$1,660
Labor value per year	$86,320
APOC per year ($500 a month plus $2K setup)	$8,000
Net benefit per store per year	$78,320

10×

return on the subscription, before counting any extra sellers served

What the labor math leaves out

Sellers who walk out of a two-hour line take their best items elsewhere. A station that keeps them in the store buys inventory the store never saw before.

Store model assumptions: Tags Technologies; validated in pilot

A $300M software market, reached one chain headquarters at a time.

$53B

US resale market, 2024, growing about 15% a year

25,000+

US resale and consignment stores; at $12K a year each, a $300M software market

$1.2M

year-3 revenue at 100 stations

Buy-sell-trade chain	Stores	Why they fit
Buffalo Exchange	~40	Family-owned, buy-counter model, known seller waits
Crossroads Trading	~30	Contemporary resale, buyer-judgment driven
Plato's Closet	475+	Franchise system; one HQ decision, hundreds of stores
Goodwill	3,000+	Donation intake; staff-station version

One chain HQ saying yes is dozens to hundreds of stations. Independents follow the chains they compete with.

Store counts: public chain profiles, 2026 · market size: industry resale reports, 2024

Software subscription per station; hardware at cost to get in the door.

STAFF STATION

$199 /mo

- 500 scans a month
- Brand ID, sizing and pricing
- Camera kit, $499 one-time
- Independent boutiques

SELL STATION

$499 /mo per station

- 2,000 scans a month
- Self-service kiosk and staff verification app
- Kiosk hardware leased at cost, [$__]/mo
- Buy-sell-trade stores and chains

ENTERPRISE

$1,299 /mo

- Unlimited scans
- Multi-station, chain buy lists, API
- Dedicated success manager
- Chain headquarters

95%
of revenue is software

85%
software gross margin; 75% blended

$12K
average contract value per year

Hardware is a customer-acquisition cost, not a profit center

Nobody else sells the whole intake: imaging, judgment, pricing and workflow.

Approach	Resale focus	Controlled imaging	Pricing	Store workflow
APOC Sell Station	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fashion vision APIs (Pixyle and similar)	No	No	No	No
ThredUp's internal tooling	Yes	Yes	Yes	Not for sale
Generic vision models	No	No	No	No
Pricing lookups and comps tools	Yes	No	Yes	No

Imaging standard

Fixed camera, fixed light, flat garment. Software-only rivals cannot match the consistency.

Verified data flywheel

Every staff sign-off is a labeled example on our imaging standard. The dataset grows with every store.

Switching cost

Hardware on the floor, the store's buy list encoded, staff trained on the queue.

Prove it in two New Orleans stores, then sell to chain headquarters.

PHASE 1 · Q1 2027

Two pilot stores

Two Sell Station prototypes, 90 days, measured on seller wait time, staff approve-unchanged rate and items per buyer-hour. Founder on site.

PHASE 2 · H2 2027

First chain pilot

Five to ten stations with one buy-sell-trade chain, sold on the pilot data. First paying stations; the pilot stores convert.

PHASE 3 · 2028

Scale by chain

Chain rollouts and franchise systems, 100 stations and $1.2M ARR by 2029. Independents follow the chains they compete with.

Sales motion

Founder-led. Free 90-day pilot that proves the numbers on the store's own floor. NARTS conference demo. One month free per referral.

Non-dilutive leverage

AWS has invited APOC into its partner-funded proof-of-concept program; if approved, partner engineering builds the cloud side at no cost to the company.

Pilot stores to be named at signing

$1.2M ARR in year three on standard vertical-SaaS math.

2027
$150K
12–15 stations · pilots convert, first chain pilot

2028
$450K
35–40 stations · first chain rollout, first hires

2029
$1.2M
100 stations · profitable at this scale on current pricing

Metric	Target	Metric	Target
Customer acquisition cost	$3K	Average contract value	$12K / yr
Payback	3 months	Lifetime value	$36K
Sales cycle	30 days	LTV to CAC	12 : 1
Annual churn	5%	Software gross margin	85%

Projections, pre-revenue; metrics are targets, not actuals

Every garment that crosses a Sell Station becomes digital inventory. That is the layer the circular economy is missing.

PHASE 1

Resale stores

Intake and pricing for 25,000 US stores. $300M software market.

PHASE 2

Recommerce operations

Returns processing, liquidation and warehouse intake: the same scan, at industrial volume.

PHASE 3

Inventory data

The largest verified dataset of secondhand garments, and the pricing and lending products it enables.

Built by someone who priced clothes for a living, hiring the engineer who scales it.

FOUNDER & CEO

Robert Jackson

Ten-plus years in vintage and resale clothing. Founded and ran Ghosts of New York (2017–2023), buying, authenticating and pricing garments daily. Built APOC from the pain of doing that by hand, and has shipped the working system, the calibration-free install and the accuracy loop as a solo founder.

Hiring plan

- Post-seed: technical co-founder, computer vision and ML, owns the Hybrid Governance Architecture
- Year 1: customer success lead for the pilot stores
- Year 2: sales and support, two hires

Advisors

- [Name], industry: 20+ years in consignment, former NARTS board
- [Name], technical: computer vision PhD, formerly Google Research
- [Name], business: three-time SaaS founder, $50M+ in exits

Advisor names to be added with their permission

Raising $500K to put the first Sell Stations on store floors.

$500K

pre-seed · SAFE or convertible note · 18 months of runway

Use of funds	Amount
Engineering: CV/ML co-founder and contract build	$175K
Sell Station prototypes and pilot hardware	$150K
Pilots, sales and marketing	$100K
Operations, cloud and legal	$75K

18-month milestones

1. Two Sell Stations live in two New Orleans stores, Q1 2027
2. First chain headquarters pilot, five to ten stations
3. 12–15 paying stations and $150K ARR
4. Technical co-founder hired; accuracy loop running on store data

Why now

Vision AI is production-ready, the hard engineering is built, resale chains are labor-constrained, and the first mover on a verified dataset keeps it.

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